

ROUND SUMMARY -- ALL TIPS AT A GLANCE

MATCH	VENUE	DATE	TIP	PROB	MARGIN	
St Kilda vs Gold Coast	Docklands	2026-08-20	St Kilda	67%	~15pts	M
Collingwood vs Brisbane Li	MCG	2026-08-21	Brisbane Lions	58%	~11pts	M
Carlton vs Fremantle	Docklands	2026-08-22	Fremantle	61%	~10pts	M
Melbourne vs Western Bulld	MCG	2026-08-22	Melbourne	66%	~14pts	M
Geelong vs Richmond	Kardinia Park	2026-08-22	Geelong	81%	~52pts	M
Adelaide vs GWS Giants	Adelaide Oval	2026-08-22	Adelaide	76%	~18pts	M
Essendon vs Port Adelaide	Docklands	2026-08-23	Port Adelaide	62%	~13pts	M
Sydney vs North Melbourne	SCG	2026-08-23	Sydney	73%	~32pts	M
West Coast vs Hawthorn	Perth Stadium	2026-08-23	Hawthorn	72%	~28pts	M

DETAILED MATCH ANALYSIS

Round 24 | Docklands | 2026-08-20

St Kilda vs Gold Coast

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: St Kilda 67% win probability approx. 15pt margin

St Kilda \$1.42 (70.3% implied) | Gold Coast \$2.89 (34.6% implied) | Line: St Kilda Saints giving 16.1 pts

ST KILDA VS GOLD COAST | ROUND 24 | 2026-08-20

PREDICTED WINNER: St Kilda

WIN PROBABILITY: St Kilda: 67% | Gold Coast: 33%

Derived from: Betting market (70.3% implied, adjusted down 3pp for overround) weighted 40%, Squiggle model (61.7%) weighted 35%, and form/venue data weighted 25%. The market and model converge on St Kilda, but both underweight Gold Coast's abysmal away record (18% win rate this season) and their -20.7 point historical average margin at Docklands, which argues for a slightly stronger St Kilda lean than either model independently suggests.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~15 points

Justified by: Betting line of 16.1 points, adjusted downward 1 point because St Kilda's last-5 average margin is -2.0 (volatile, close losses to Carlton and Sydney), and Gold Coast has conceded an average of 94.6 points over their last 5 games. St Kilda at Docklands historical average margin is +4.9 over 330 games; Gold Coast at Docklands historical margin is -20.7 over 43 games. The line sits between these extremes, supported by Squiggle's 18.1 point expectation.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Home Ground Effect (Quantified): St Kilda holds a 48% all-time home win rate vs. 30% away; Gold Coast shows the inverse pattern with only 18% away win rate this season (37 percentage points below their 55% home rate). At Docklands specifically, St Kilda's historical record is 55% (181W-149L) vs. Gold Coast's 30% (13W-30L). This single factor is worth approximately 8-15 points in AFL, anchoring the prediction toward St Kilda.
2. Defensive Vulnerability (Gold Coast): Gold Coast has conceded an average of 94.6 points over the last 5 games and 95.3 over the last 3 games, with a defensive trend marked "stable" (not improving). St Kilda's last-5 attack average is 82.4 points, suggesting Gold Coast's defence is the weaker link in this matchup. Gold Coast's average margin is -14.2 over 5 games, indicating systemic defensive leakage.
3. Inconsistency in St Kilda Attack: St Kilda's last-5 record shows wins of +49 and +31 alternating with losses of -44, -19, and -27. Attack trend is stable at 82.4 ppg, but scoring volatility is extreme. Against a team conceding 94.6 ppg, St Kilda should find points easier, but the variance means a low-scoring St Kilda day is plausible (evidenced by the 62-point loss to Carlton 6 days ago).
4. Gold Coast Away Collapse: Gold Coast's 2W-11L away record (18% win rate) represents a 37-point gap vs. their home performance. They have lost 4 of their last 5 games, with average margin -14.2. Playing away on short rest (5 days) against a team with +18pp home edge historically stacks structural disadvantage.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

St Kilda (last 5): 82.4 ppg for, 84.4 ppg against | Average margin: -2.0 pts
St Kilda (last 3): 81.3 ppg for, 86.0 ppg against
- Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Stable
- Insight: St Kilda's scoring is stable but slightly negative (outscored in 4 of last 5). However, their 81-82 ppg aligns with Gold Coast's defensive concession rate of 94.6 ppg, suggesting St Kilda's attack will find easier paths.

Gold Coast (last 5): 80.4 ppg for, 94.6 ppg against | Average margin: -14.2 pts
Gold Coast (last 3): 79.0 ppg for, 95.3 ppg against
- Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Stable
- Insight: Gold Coast's attack is collapsing (79 ppg in last 3) while their defence is leaking 95+ ppg consistently. This is a team losing via poor defence, not poor attack. The gap between their output (79 ppg) and St Kilda's output (81 ppg) is negligible, but the gap between Gold Coast's defence (95.3) and St Kilda's defence (86.0) is 9.3 points per game--a significant advantage to St Kilda.

Scoring advantage: St Kilda, due to Gold Coast's defensive instability.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

St Kilda this season: 4W-10L at home (40%) | 6W-12L away (50%)
- Note: St Kilda's home record (40%) is weaker than expected, suggesting some suppression of home advantage this year.

Gold Coast this season: 6W-11L at home (55%) | 2W-11L away (18%)
- Home advantage quantified: +37 percentage points (55% vs. 18%).

At Docklands (this season, last 5 games):
- St Kilda: 3W-2L at Docklands | Average margin: +9.8 pts
- Gold Coast: 3W-2L at Docklands | Average margin: +12.0 pts

Historical record at Docklands (all-time):
- St Kilda: 181W-149L (55%) | Average: 92.3 for vs. 87.4 against (+4.9 margin) over 330 games
- Gold Coast: 13W-30L (30%) | Average: 75.8 for vs. 96.6 against (-20.7 margin) over 43 games

Estimated home advantage for this match: 12-15 points. St Kilda's all-time home edge is +18pp (48% home vs. 30% away). Gold

Coast's structural away weakness is -37pp this season. The Docklands-specific data shows St Kilda at +4.9 historically and Gold Coast at -20.7 historically--a 25-point swing. Conservative estimate: 12-15 points in St Kilda's favour from venue alone.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Win Market: St Kilda \$1.42 (70.3% implied) | Gold Coast \$2.89 (34.6% implied)

- Interpretation: Market is heavily favoring St Kilda. After removing standard 5-6% overround, true market probability is ~67-68% St Kilda.

Line Market: St Kilda giving 16.1 points

- Interpretation: Market expects a 16-point St Kilda win, consistent with the 70% win probability (larger favourites typically win by larger margins).

Totals Market: ~182 points expected

- Interpretation: This implies St Kilda ~99 points, Gold Coast ~83 points. Aligns with recent scoring: St Kilda 82.4 ppg, Gold Coast 80.4 ppg.

Squiggle Model: St Kilda 61.7% win probability | Predicted margin 18.1 points

- Interpretation: Model predicts a larger margin (18.1) than market line (16.1). Model may be weighting defensive metrics (Gold Coast's -20.7 margin at Docklands) more heavily than the market.

Convergence & Divergence:

- Agreement: All three sources (market, model, form) converge on St Kilda as the clear favourite.

- Divergence: Market line (16.1) vs. Squiggle margin (18.1). This 2-point gap is modest; both suggest a St Kilda win by mid-to-high teen points.

- Weighting decision: I weighted the market win probability (70.3% -> 67% after overround) at 40%, Squ

Round 24 | MCG | 2026-08-21

Collingwood vs Brisbane Lions

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Brisbane Lions

58% win probability approx. 11pt margin

Collingwood \$4.09 (24.5% implied) | Brisbane Lions \$1.24 (80.6% implied) | Line: Brisbane Lions giving 25.8 pts

COLLINGWOOD vs BRISBANE LIONS -- ROUND 24 PREDICTION

PREDICTED WINNER: Brisbane Lions

WIN PROBABILITY: Collingwood: 42% | Brisbane Lions: 58%

Derivation: Weighted 35% to Squiggle model (53.4% Brisbane), 35% to betting market adjusted for overround (implied ~81% Brisbane corrects to ~58% after removing bookmaker margin), and 30% to recent form and H2H data (Brisbane 4W-1L last 5, Collingwood 3W-2L, Brisbane +23.2 pts average margin vs Collingwood +9.8 pts). The three sources show consistent agreement on Brisbane superiority, with only the magnitude varying.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~11 points (Brisbane Lions)

Anchor: Squiggle model expects 5.1 pts Brisbane margin. Betting line gives Brisbane 25.8 pts -- implausibly wide and likely reflects overestimation of Brisbane's advantage or underestimation of home ground effect. Brisbane's last-5 average margin (+23.2 pts) is inflated by an outlier 67-pt win vs Hawthorn; excluding that yields +25 avg over 4 games. Collingwood's last-3 shows defensive

deterioration (95.7 pts conceded avg vs 86.0 pts last-5), but not catastrophic. H2H history shows Collingwood's last two wins at MCG were tight (+1 pt in 2024, +13 pts in 2025). Predicted margin of ~11 pts reflects Brisbane's scoring superiority (+23.2 vs +9.8 pts average margin), tempered by Collingwood home ground advantage worth ~4.4 pts historically at MCG.

KEY FACTORS:

- Brisbane's recent dominance in scoring margin (+23.2 pts last 5 vs Collingwood's +9.8 pts): This 13.4-point differential in average margin is the single largest performance gap between the teams. Brisbane has won 4 of its last 5 games; Collingwood has won 3 of 5. Brisbane's attack is stable at 103.4 pts per game (last 5) while Collingwood's is 95.8 pts -- a 7.6 pt output gap that compounds the margin advantage.
- H2H record shows Brisbane dominance (6W-4L last 10 meetings, 40% Collingwood win rate): In the last 5 meetings, Brisbane has won 3 straight before Collingwood recovered 2 wins. However, Brisbane's most recent win at MCG (Round 25, 2025) was by 29 pts (100-71). Collingwood's last two MCG wins were both tight margins (+1 pt and +13 pts). This suggests Brisbane has the tools to control this matchup even away from home.
- Collingwood's defensive deterioration (95.7 pts conceded last 3 games vs 86.0 pts last 5): A 9.7-point increase in points conceded over the last 3 weeks is material. Brisbane's average score of 103.4 pts per game will likely exceed what Collingwood has been able to contain recently. Brisbane's defence is also leaking (+80.2 to +88.3 pts conceded), but the deterioration is smaller (8.1 pts).
- Home ground advantage at MCG historically favours Collingwood but is tempered by Brisbane's season strength: Collingwood's historical MCG record is 392W-336L (54% win rate, +4.4 pt average margin). Brisbane's MCG record is 24W-47L (34% win rate, -9.5 pt average margin). However, this season at MCG both teams are 3W-2L; Brisbane's last 5 MCG games show +12.6 pt average margin (nearly 3x their historical average). This suggests Brisbane has improved significantly at this venue in recent seasons, though the sample is small (5 games).

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Collingwood (last 5):

- For: 95.8 pts/game | Against: 86.0 pts/game | Average margin: +9.8 pts
- Last 3: For 93.7 pts/game | Against: 95.7 pts/game | Average margin: -2.0 pts
- Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Leaking more ^

Brisbane Lions (last 5):

- For: 103.4 pts/game | Against: 80.2 pts/game | Average margin: +23.2 pts
- Last 3: For 99.3 pts/game | Against: 88.3 pts/game | Average margin: +11.0 pts
- Attack trend: Stable | Defence trend: Leaking more ^

Advantage analysis: Brisbane has a clear scoring advantage. Their attack (+7.6 pts output over Collingwood on average) is stable and higher-volume. More critically, Brisbane's defence (80.2 pts conceded last 5) is substantially better than Collingwood's (86.0 pts conceded). Both teams' defences are tightening slightly in the last 3 games, but Brisbane's defensive baseline is superior. Collingwood's last-3 data is concerning: they are now conceding more than they score (95.7 vs 93.7), suggesting defensive vulnerability that Brisbane's stable, high-volume attack (+103.4 pts average) will exploit.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Season Records:

- Collingwood: Home 6W-11L (55%) | Away 7W-11L (64%)
- Brisbane Lions: Home 8W-11L (73%) | Away 7W-11L (64%)

Venue-Specific (MCG, last 5 games):

- Collingwood at MCG: 3W-2L | +11.2 pts average margin

- Brisbane at MCG: 3W-2L | +12.6 pts average margin

Historical MCG Records (all-time):

- Collingwood: 392W-336L (54% win rate) | avg 89.0 for vs 84.6 against | +4.4 pt margin (728 games)
- Brisbane: 24W-47L (34% win rate) | avg 86.5 for vs 96.0 against | -9.5 pt margin (71 games)

Estimated home ground advantage: AFL convention places home advantage at 8-15 pts. Collingwood's historical +4.4 pt MCG margin is below this range, suggesting MCG is a neutral to slightly favourable venue for Collingwood, not a fortress. Brisbane's -9.5 pt historical MCG margin is heavily negative, but this is driven by older data and may not reflect current form; their last 5 MCG games show +12.6 pts average, a massive reversal. For this match, home advantage is estimated at +4 to +5 pts for Collingwood, considerably below standard AFL home advantage because Collingwood's MCG record is not exceptional, and Brisbane has recently overperformed at this venue. This tempers Collingwood's home edge.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Betting Market (H2H): Collingwood \$4.09 (24.5% implied) | Brisbane Lions \$1.24 (80.6% implied). These imply probabilities sum to 105.1%, meaning the bookmaker's margin (overround) is 5.1 pp. Adjusted for fair probability: Collingwood ~23% | Brisbane ~77%. This is materially more bullish on Brisbane than the Squiggle model.

Line Market: Brisbane giving 25.8 pts. This is substantially wider than the Squiggle model's 5.1 pt prediction and even wider than the recent 5-game average margin gap (13.4 pts). A 25.8 pt line suggests bookmakers expect Brisbane to dominate decisively; this appears overestimated.

Totals Market: Market expects ~182 total points. Average combined scoring: Collingwood 95.8 + Brisbane 103.4 = 199.2 pts (last 5). The market total is 8.8% below recent combined scoring

Round 24 | Docklands | 2026-08-22

Carlton vs Fremantle

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Fremantle

61% win probability approx. 10pt margin

Carlton \$2.4 (41.6% implied) | Fremantle \$1.58 (63.4% implied) | Line: Fremantle Dockers giving 9.8 pts

CARLTON VS FREMANTLE -- ROUND 24 PREDICTION

PREDICTED WINNER: Fremantle

WIN PROBABILITY: Carlton: 39% | Fremantle: 61%

Derivation: Weighted average of three sources: Squiggle model (57.1% Fremantle) weighted at 40%, betting market (63.4% Fremantle implied, adjusted for overround to ~58%) weighted at 35%, and form/ladder data weighted at 25%. The three sources show consistent directional agreement on a Fremantle win, though the market overestimates Fremantle's chances slightly due to overround. I reduced the market's raw 63.4% to ~58% after adjusting for typical 4-6% overround, then blended conservatively.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~10 points (Fremantle by)

Justification: The Squiggle model predicts 10.8 pts; the line market is Fremantle -9.8 pts. These align closely. Carlton's recent form

shows average margin of +22.4 pts over last 5, but Fremantle's superior ladder position (19W-3L vs 11W-10L) and consistent +31.0 pts average margin over the same period is the stronger signal. Home ground advantage (~8-15 pts in typical AFL matches) will partly offset Carlton's Docklands record, but Fremantle's 27 percentage-point advantage in home/away win rates (away 73% vs home 60% for Carlton) suggests the venue effect is material but not dominant.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Ladder Position & Overall Dominance: Fremantle holds position 1 with 19W-3L; Carlton is 10th with 11W-10L. Fremantle's percentage (142.47%) exceeds Carlton's (99.58%) by 42.89 points. This reflects a sustained structural advantage across the season, not a one-week anomaly.
2. Recent Scoring Efficiency: Fremantle's last 5 average margin is +31.0 pts vs Carlton's +22.4 pts. Crucially, Fremantle's last 3 shows defensive tightening despite declining attack (99.7 pts for, 80.7 against), while Carlton's last 3 shows improved attack (114.0 pts for) but only stable defence (74.0 against). Fremantle can afford to score less if defence holds; Carlton cannot.
3. Home Ground Venue Performance: Carlton's record at Docklands in last 5 games is 4W-1L (+37.2 pts avg margin) -- strong. However, this is heavily influenced by opposition quality; historically at Docklands, Carlton averages 89.5 pts and concedes 98.7 pts (39% win rate over 190 games, -9.2 margin). Fremantle's historical record at Docklands is also poor (36% win rate, -13.1 margin), but recent performance (3W-2L, -16.8 margin) suggests recency trumps long-term history when teams are in good form.
4. Injury Impact on Fremantle's Ruck Division: Murphy Reid is unlikely to return (groin injury from loss to Melbourne); Sean Darcy received "positive" scan news on calf but remains at risk. Fremantle will deploy a weakened ruck setup, potentially favouring Carlton's aerial contest. However, Fremantle's 19-win season was achieved with uncertainty in this position, so ruckman availability is not a new variable.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Carlton:

- Last 5: 104.2 pts for, 81.8 pts against
- Last 3: 114.0 pts for, 74.0 pts against
- Attack: improving ^ | Defence: stable
- Analysis: Carlton's attack has sharpened noticeably (104.2 -> 114.0 pts). Defence remains consistent but not elite (74.0-81.8 pts conceded). The trend favours Carlton's ability to score, but scoring alone does not win against a team that scores 102.8 and concedes only 71.8.

Fremantle:

- Last 5: 102.8 pts for, 71.8 pts against
- Last 3: 99.7 pts for, 80.7 pts against
- Attack: stable | Defence: leaking more ^
- Analysis: Fremantle's attack has declined (102.8 -> 99.7 pts), a concerning trend. Defence has deteriorated sharply (71.8 -> 80.7 pts). The loss to Melbourne (109-113, -4 pts) and a closer-than-expected win over Adelaide (112-88, +24 pts) suggest Fremantle is vulnerable. However, a scoring margin of +31.0 pts over the last 5 games is still elite, and the 80.7 pts conceded in the last 3 is still superior to Carlton's 74.0 conceded (Fremantle's opponent quality may be higher, inflating their conceding numbers).

Advantage: Slight to Carlton. Carlton's attack trend is more favourable, and if they can score 110+ points, they have a realistic chance. However, Fremantle's overall scoring efficiency (margin-based) remains superior.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Season Record:

- Carlton: Home 6/10 (60%), Away 6/12 (50%) -- 10 percentage-point home advantage

- Fremantle: Home 11/11 (100%), Away 8/11 (73%) -- 27 percentage-point home advantage

Venue-Specific (Docklands):

- Carlton last 5: 4W-1L, +37.2 margin (recent form very strong at home)
- Carlton historical (190 games): 39% win rate, -9.2 margin
- Fremantle last 5: 3W-2L, -16.8 margin (recent form poor at this venue)
- Fremantle historical (77 games): 36% win rate, -13.1 margin

Estimated Home Advantage: ~8-12 points for Carlton at Docklands. The venue's large crowd capacity (52,000+), Carlton's familiarity, and Fremantle's consistent historical underperformance here (36% win rate, 28 fewer wins than losses across 77 games) suggest the ground disadvantage is real. However, Carlton's season home/away split (+10pp) is weaker than Fremantle's away discount (-27pp from their home rate), suggesting Fremantle's quality transcends venue effects more than Carlton's does.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- H2H Market (Win/Loss): Carlton \$2.40 (implied 41.6%), Fremantle \$1.58 (implied 63.4%). Overround is ~5%, adjusting market probability to ~58-60% for Fremantle.
- Line Market: Fremantle -9.8 pts. This aligns closely with Squiggle's 10.8 pt prediction.
- Squiggle Model: Fremantle 57.1% to win, expected margin 10.8 pts.

Agreement: All three sources (win market, line market, Squiggle) agree Fremantle is the favourite by a narrow margin (~10 pts, ~57-60% win probability). No significant disagreement.

Weighting Decision: I weighted Squiggle at 40% (most robust given it incorporates all-season data), line market at 35% (forward-looking, less subject to overround), and form/ladder at 25%. This produced 61% Fremantle, slightly higher than the raw market but conservative relative to Squiggle's 57%.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

- Carlton: 6 days rest (short turnaround -- fatigue risk). Home ground, no travel.
- Fremantle: 8 days rest. Long-haul travel: Perth -> Melbourne (~3h 45m flight) + time zone adjustment (30 min behind).

Analysis: Carlton is at a rest disadvantage (6 vs 8 days). However, Carlton is at home, which typically

Round 24 | MCG | 2026-08-22

Melbourne vs Western Bulldogs

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Melbourne

66% win probability approx. 14pt margin

Melbourne \$1.41 (70.9% implied) | Western Bulldogs \$2.9 (34.5% implied) | Line: Melbourne Demons giving 16.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Melbourne

WIN PROBABILITY: Melbourne: 66% | Western Bulldogs: 34%

Derived from weighted average of: Squiggle model (59.9% Melbourne, weight 40%), betting market (70.9% Melbourne adjusted for overround, weight 35%), and form/ladder positioning (weight 25%). The model and market both favour Melbourne; form data supports this via 4/5 recent wins and significant ladder separation (5th vs 9th).

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~14 points

Line market expects 16.5 pts; Squiggle model expects 15.2 pts. Melbourne's last-5 average margin is +17.0 pts, last-3 is stronger at an implied ~20 pts (119.7 for vs 90.0 against). Conservative estimate of 14 pts accounts for Western Bulldogs' recent slight improvement (2/5 wins vs 4/5 for Melbourne) and home-ground psychological effects, though the match is at MCG.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Ladder separation & season record: Melbourne sits 5th (15W-7L, 60 pts) vs Western Bulldogs 9th (12W-9L, 50 pts) -- a 3-win gap with 10 percentage points advantage (111.2% vs 94.1%). This structural difference correlates with 15-17 point margin prediction across multiple models.
2. Recent form divergence: Melbourne won 4/5 with average margin +17.0 pts; Western Bulldogs won 2/5 with average margin +1.2 pts. Most critically, Melbourne's last 3 games show improved attack (119.7 pts avg) and stable defence (90.0 pts avg), while Western Bulldogs' last 3 show collapsing attack (66.7 pts avg, trending v) and leaking defence (86.7 pts avg, trending ^).
3. MCG venue history (critical): Melbourne has 52% historical win rate at MCG (674-623, avg margin +2.0 pts) and 4W-1L in last 5 games there (avg margin +16.6 pts). Western Bulldogs has only 41% historical win rate at MCG (91-132, avg margin -7.9 pts). This 16+ point historical disadvantage for the Bulldogs at this venue is substantial.
4. Home ground advantage (quantified): Melbourne's home win rate this season is 80% (8/10) vs away 58% (7/12) -- a 22 percentage point swing. While Western Bulldogs show no home/away differential this season (55%/55%), their -7.9 point average margin at MCG historically negates any tactical home ground effects they might possess.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Melbourne: Last 5 avg: 109.6 pts for, 92.6 pts against | Last 3 avg: 119.7 pts for, 90.0 pts against. Attack trending ^ (improvement from 109.6 to 119.7 pts), Defence stable. Scoring profile: Melbourne's improving attack and consistent defence creates a widening advantage; they've scored 113+, 114, and 132 pts in their last 3 games while keeping opponents to 90 or below.

Western Bulldogs: Last 5 avg: 76.4 pts for, 75.2 pts against | Last 3 avg: 66.7 pts for, 86.7 pts against. Attack trending v (deterioration from 76.4 to 66.7 pts), Defence leaking more ^ (deterioration from 75.2 to 86.7 pts). Scoring profile: Western Bulldogs' collapsing attack (66.7 pts in last 3) represents the most concerning metric in this dataset; they've scored only 41, 77, and 82 pts in their last 3 games.

Advantage: Melbourne by a significant margin. The Bulldogs' 42.9 point deficit in combined scoring differential over the last 3 games (Melbourne +29.7, Western Bulldogs -20.0) is the single most predictive factor visible in this data.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Melbourne Season Record: Home 8/10 (80%) | Away 7/12 (58%) -- 22 percentage point home advantage.

Western Bulldogs Season Record: Home 6/11 (55%) | Away 6/11 (55%) -- no measurable home/away differential this season.

Venue-Specific (MCG):

- Melbourne at MCG (last 5): 4W-1L, avg margin +16.6 pts
- Melbourne at MCG (historical): 674W-623L (52% win rate), avg 86.1 vs 84.1 (margin +2.0 pts over 1297 games)
- Western Bulldogs at MCG (last 5): 3W-2L, avg margin +12.0 pts
- Western Bulldogs at MCG (historical): 91W-132L (41% win rate), avg 89.1 vs 97.0 (margin -7.9 pts over 223 games)

Home ground advantage estimate for this match: ~10-12 points in Melbourne's favour. The MCG is not Melbourne's traditional fortress (Collingwood, Essendon, Hawthorn historically dominate), but Western Bulldogs have a stark historical weakness there (-7.9 pt average margin). While both teams play here regularly, Melbourne's 22pp season home advantage combined

with Western Bulldogs' -7.9 pt MCG disadvantage creates a compounding structural advantage for the Demons.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

Win/Loss Market: Melbourne \$1.41 (70.9% implied) | Western Bulldogs \$2.9 (34.5% implied). Note: These sum to 105.4%, indicating a 5.4% bookmaker overround. Adjusted fair probabilities: Melbourne ~67%, Western Bulldogs ~33%.

Line Market: Melbourne giving 16.5 pts. This is consistent with Squiggle's 15.2 pt expected margin and Melbourne's last-5 average of +17.0 pts.

Squiggle Model: Melbourne 59.9% win probability, expected margin 15.2 pts.

Agreement Assessment:

- Betting market (adjusted 67%) agrees with Squiggle (59.9%) -- both favour Melbourne by ~7-8 percentage points.
- Line market (16.5 pts) agrees with Squiggle margin (15.2 pts) and form data (last-5 average +17.0 pts).
- All three data sources (market, model, form) converge on a Melbourne victory by 14-17 points.

Weight Applied: 40% Squiggle (most rigorous statistical framework), 35% betting market (reflects aggregated professional assessment, adjusted for overround), 25% form (subject to recency bias but shows clear recent divergence in favour of Melbourne). I weighted Squiggle slightly lower than my standard 50% because recent form (Melbourne's last-3 attack at 119.7 pts) has moved meaningfully beyond the Squiggle estimate, suggesting real momentum not yet fully captured by the model.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Melbourne: 7 days rest. Playing at home (MCG, Melbourne). No fatigue or travel penalty.

Western Bulldogs: 6 days rest (short turnaround vs Melbourne's 7 days). Playing at home (Docklands/MCG, Melbourne). Minor fatigue risk identified. While Western Bulldogs' home ground is technically the MCG/Docklands precinct, the 1-day rest disadvantage is marginal in AFL terms (typically fatigues manifest over <4 days rest or >10 days without match conditioning). However, combined with recent form collapse (last 3 games averaging 66.7 pts), the cumulative effect of short rest on a struggling attack is non-trivial.

Assessment: Fatigue is a minor negative factor for Western Bulldogs but not a primary driver of the prediction. The 7-day vs 6-day difference is

Round 24 | Kardinia Park | 2026-08-22

Geelong vs Richmond

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Geelong

81% win probability approx. 52pt margin

Geelong \$1.02 (98.2% implied) | Richmond \$16.23 (6.2% implied) | Line: Geelong Cats giving 60.5 pts

GEELONG vs RICHMOND | ROUND 24 | 2026-08-22 | KARDINIA PARK

PREDICTED WINNER: Geelong

WIN PROBABILITY: Geelong: 81% | Richmond: 19%

(Weighted 40% from Squiggle model [79.3%], 35% from form differential and scoring margins [Geelong +30.8 avg margin vs Richmond -34.8], and 25% from betting market implied probability [98.2%]. The market is overrounding; true probability removes that overround.

Form data and Squiggle align closely, increasing confidence in the 81% estimate.)

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~52 points

(Anchored to Squiggle expected margin of 50.8 pts and line market of 60.5 pts. Averaging these and accounting for Richmond's slight defensive tightening trend (61.0 pts conceded last 3 vs 91.4 last 5), a 52-point margin represents a midpoint that avoids over-weighting the market's aggressive 60.5 pts line while respecting the 30+ point margins Geelong has consistently posted.)

KEY FACTORS:

- Recent form disparity is extreme: Geelong has won 5 consecutive games with an average margin of +30.8 pts (scoring 111.6 for, 80.8 against). Richmond has lost 4 of 5 with an average margin of -34.8 pts (scoring 56.6 for, 91.4 against). The differential between these two sequences is 65.6 points -- this is not a close matchup.
- Venue dominance by Geelong: Geelong's record at Kardinia Park is 500W-237L (68% win rate) with an average margin of +18.2 pts (500 games). Richmond's record at Kardinia Park is 15W-38L (28% win rate) with an average margin of -20.5 pts (53 games). Richmond has lost both its last 2 visits to Kardinia Park by an average of -51.0 pts.
- Home ground advantage is quantified and significant: Geelong's home win rate (91%, 10/11) is 55 percentage points higher than its away win rate (36%, 4/11). Richmond's away record (9%, 1/11) is worse than its home record (18%, 2/11), indicating Richmond performs poorly as an away team. Geelong's all-time home advantage at Kardinia Park adds 23 percentage points to its win rate versus away venues.
- Scoring efficiency favours Geelong's defence: Geelong's defence has conceded 80.8 pts per game (last 5) and 77.3 pts per game (last 3), both stable and tight. Richmond's attack is scoring only 56.6 pts per game (last 5) and 61.0 pts per game (last 3) -- far below league average. The gap between Geelong's defensive concession rate and Richmond's attacking output is 19.8 pts per game.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

- Geelong (last 5): 111.6 pts for, 80.8 pts against | (last 3): 113.0 pts for, 77.3 pts against
- Attack trend: Stable (improving slightly from 111.6 to 113.0)
 - Defence trend: Stable (improving slightly from 80.8 to 77.3)
 - Advantage to Geelong: Geelong is scoring efficiently (113.0 avg last 3) while conceding very little (77.3 avg last 3). Both attack and defence are performing at or above levels needed to beat a struggling Richmond outfit.
- Richmond (last 5): 56.6 pts for, 91.4 pts against | (last 3): 61.0 pts for, 76.7 pts against
- Attack trend: Stable (slight improvement from 56.6 to 61.0)
 - Defence trend: Tightening (improving from 91.4 to 76.7, a reduction of 14.7 pts conceded per game)
 - Advantage to Geelong: Richmond's attack remains severely below-par at 61.0 pts per game, even with the defensive tightening. Richmond's 61.0 pts per game would rank in the bottom 2-3 teams in the AFL. Against Geelong's 77.3 concession average, this creates a structural mismatch. Richmond's defensive improvement is a minor positive but insufficient to bridge a 16-point scoring gap.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

- Geelong this season:
- Home: 10/11 (91%)
 - Away: 4/11 (36%)
 - Home ground advantage: +55 percentage points
- Richmond this season:
- Home: 2/11 (18%)
 - Away: 1/11 (9%)

- No discernible home advantage; both records are poor

Venue-specific data (Kardinia Park):

- Geelong at Kardinia Park (last 5): 4W-1L, avg margin +28.8 pts
- Geelong at Kardinia Park (all-time, 737 games): 500W-237L (68% win rate), avg margin +18.2 pts
- Richmond at Kardinia Park (last 2): 0W-2L, avg margin -51.0 pts
- Richmond at Kardinia Park (all-time, 53 games): 15W-38L (28% win rate), avg margin -20.5 pts

Estimated point value of home advantage for this match: AFL home ground advantage is typically worth 8-15 pts at standard venues. Kardinia Park is a Geelong fortress (68% win rate, 500+ games played there) where Richmond has a historical win rate of only 28%. The venue-specific data suggests this is a high-attendance fortress with strong crowd noise benefit to Geelong. Conservatively, home advantage here is worth 18-22 pts (above the league standard).

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Market (Win/Loss):

- Geelong: \$1.02 (implied 98.2% win probability)
- Richmond: \$16.23 (implied 6.2% win probability)
- Market interpretation: The market is pricing Geelong as a near-certainty. The 98.2% implied probability includes bookmaker overround (~4-6% per side), so true market probability for Geelong is approximately 94-96%.

Line Market:

- Geelong giving 60.5 pts
- Market interpretation: The market expects Geelong to win by approximately 60.5 points, suggesting confidence in a dominant performance.

Totals Market:

- Market expects total score ~184 pts
- Market interpretation: This implies Geelong ~122 pts, Richmond ~62 pts (assuming a 60-point margin split). This is consistent with Geelong's recent scoring averages (111.6-113.0) and Richmond's extreme offensive weakness (56.6-61.0).

Squiggle Statistical Model:

- Geelong win probability: 79.3%
- Expected margin: 50.8 pts
- Model interpretation: Squiggle is materially more conservative than the betting market, assigning Richmond a 20.7% chance. The 50.8 pt expected margin is 9.7 pts lower than the line market.

Agreement/Disagreement:

- Agreement: All three sources (H2H market, line market, Squiggle model, and form data) agree Geelong will win decisively.
- Disagreement on magnitude: The H2H market (98.2%) and line market (60.5 pts) are more aggressive than Squiggle (79.3%, 50.8 pts). Squiggle's more conservative estimate may reflect regression-to-the-mean statistical assumptions, whereas the market is reacting to Richmond's actual 3W-19L record and 1W-4L recent form.
- Weighting decision: I weighted Squiggle at 40%, form data at 35%, and market at 25% for the win probability. For margin, I averaged Squiggle (

Round 24 | Adelaide Oval | 2026-08-22

Adelaide vs GWS Giants

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Adelaide 76% win probability approx. 18pt margin

Adelaide \$1.25 (80.2% implied) | GWS Giants \$4.03 (24.8% implied) | Line: Adelaide Crows giving 25.5 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Adelaide

WIN PROBABILITY: Adelaide: 76% | GWS Giants: 24%

Derivation: Weighted 40% to venue-specific data (Adelaide's 59% home record at Adelaide Oval vs GWS's 45%), 35% to recent form (Adelaide 3/5 wins, +7.8pt avg margin vs GWS 2/5 wins, +2.0pt margin), 15% to betting market (\$1.25 for Adelaide = 80.2% implied, adjusted downward for overround), and 10% to rest/travel (Adelaide +2 days rest, home ground eliminates travel fatigue). The Squiggle model is unavailable, so no adjustment applied.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~18 points (Adelaide by)

Justification: Betting line is 25.5pts (Adelaide giving), which incorporates overround. Adelaide's historical margin at Adelaide Oval is +13.0pts (160 games); GWS's is -7.0pts (20 games). Recent venue form shows Adelaide +9.0pts (5 games) and GWS -10.0pts (5 games). Heavy rain forecast (78% probability, 1.4mm) typically reduces margins and benefits underdogs by 5-10pts. Blending venue averages (+13.0), recent venue performance (+9.0), GWS underdog status (+5-7pts from rain), and regressing to the betting line yields ~18pts.

KEY FACTORS:

- Home ground dominance is substantial and repeatable. Adelaide's win rate at Adelaide Oval is 59% (95W-65L over 160 games, +13.0pt avg margin). GWS's record at Adelaide Oval is 45% (9W-11L over 20 games, -7.0pt avg margin). This 14-percentage-point advantage at the specific venue, repeated over 180 games of data, is not noise. Home ground advantage is typically worth 8-15pts in AFL; this data suggests +13-20pts for Adelaide at this ground.
- Recent form favours Adelaide in both attack and defence. Adelaide has averaged 91.4pts for and 83.6pts against over the last 5 games (+7.8pt margin), with improvement in the last 3 games (98.7pts for, 79.7pts against). GWS has averaged 83.0pts for and 81.0pts against over 5 games (+2.0pt margin). Adelaide is scoring 8.4pts more per game and conceding 2.6pts less. Both teams' attack and defence are listed as "stable," but the gap is real.
- GWS's away record this season is poor: 2W-10L (20% win rate). This is 47 percentage points worse than their home record (67%, 8W-12L). While travel to Adelaide is only ~1h45m, the away record is functionally a strong predictor of underperformance. GWS have won only 2 of 10 away games; Adelaide have won 6 of 11 away games.
- Heavy rain (78% forecast, 1.4mm) will compress the margin but should not flip the outcome. Rain benefits underdogs by an estimated 5-10pts because it reduces the effectiveness of high-marking forwards and increases contested play. GWS's recent form does not suggest they have an edge in wet-weather football (stable attack/defence trends, not improving). The rain moves the line from ~25.5pts to an expected ~18pts, but does not neutralise Adelaide's venue and form advantage.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

Adelaide (last 5 games): 91.4pts for, 83.6pts against. Last 3: 98.7pts for, 79.7pts against.
Attack trend: Stable. Defence trend: Stable. Note: While both trends are marked stable, the most recent 3-game sample shows +7.0pt improvement in attack (from 91.4 to 98.7) and +3.9pt improvement in defence (from 83.6 to 79.7), suggesting a gentle upward trajectory.

GWS Giants (last 5 games): 83.0pts for, 81.0pts against. Last 3: 87.7pts for, 66.3pts against.
Attack trend: Stable. Defence trend: Tightening v (improving). Note: The most recent 3-game sample shows +4.7pt improvement in attack (from 83.0 to 87.7) and +14.7pt improvement in defence (from 81.0 to 66.3). GWS's defence is tightening, which is a genuine positive.

Comparison: Adelaide's scoring profile (98.7pts for in last 3) gives them a +11.0pt scoring advantage over GWS's last-3 attack

(87.7pts). However, GWS's defence has tightened significantly in the last 3 games (66.3pts conceded vs 79.7 for Adelaide), creating a -13.4pt swing. Net: Adelaide's attack is stronger, but GWS's recent defence improvement is material. In wet conditions, Adelaide's attack advantage may not translate fully; GWS's defence tightening is a real mitigating factor.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

Adelaide this season:

Home: 8W-11L (73% win rate)

Away: 6W-11L (55% win rate)

Difference: +18 percentage points at home.

GWS Giants this season:

Home: 8W-12L (67% win rate)

Away: 2W-10L (20% win rate)

Difference: +47 percentage points at home. This is an unusually large swing and indicates GWS are substantially weaker on the road.

Adelaide at Adelaide Oval (last 5): 3W-2L, +9.0pt avg margin.

GWS Giants at Adelaide Oval (last 5): 2W-3L, -10.0pt avg margin.

Historical venue record:

Adelaide at Adelaide Oval: 95W-65L (59% win rate), avg 90.6 vs 77.6 (+13.0pt margin) over 160 games.

GWS Giants at Adelaide Oval: 9W-11L (45% win rate), avg 74.5 vs 81.5 (-7.0pt margin) over 20 games.

Home ground advantage estimate: For Adelaide, home advantage at Adelaide Oval is worth approximately +13 to +15 points based on the historical margin and season win-rate differential. For GWS, the away deficit is approximately -15 to -20 points based on their season away record (20%) and the swing from home (67%). The net effect is Adelaide's home advantage at this venue is very strong -- estimated at +13 to +18 points above a neutral ground.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

H2H Market (Win/Loss): Adelaide \$1.25 (80.2% implied), GWS Giants \$4.03 (24.8% implied).

Interpretation: The market views Adelaide as a strong favourite, but the implied probability includes the bookmaker's overround (~4-6% typically). Adjusted for overround, Adelaide's true probability is approximately 76-78%.

Line Market: Adelaide giving 25.5pts.

Interpretation: The market expects Adelaide to win by 25.5pts. This is above the venue-adjusted estimate of +13 to +20pts but in the same direction.

Squiggle Model: Not available for this match.

Impact: Cannot triangulate. Relying on betting market, form, and venue data only.

Data conflict: The line market (25.5pts) is larger than the venue-historical average (13pts) and the season-wide home advantage estimate (13-18pts). This suggests the market is pricing in either: (a) sharper expectations of Adelaide's form improvement (last 3 games: 98.7pts for), or (b) weakness in GWS's away performance (20% win rate), or (c) overestimation of the favourite.

Resolution: I have weighted the venue data (59% vs 45%, +13-18pts) more heavily than

Round 24 | Docklands | 2026-08-23

Essendon vs Port Adelaide

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Port Adelaide 62% win probability approx. 13pt margin
Essendon \$2.2 (45.4% implied) | Port Adelaide \$1.68 (59.7% implied) | Line: Port Adelaide Power giving 6.5 pts

PREDICTION: Essendon vs Port Adelaide | Round 24 | 2026-08-23

PREDICTED WINNER: Port Adelaide

WIN PROBABILITY: Essendon: 38% | Port Adelaide: 62%

Derived from a weighted average: Squiggle model 59.0% for Port Adelaide (40% weight) + betting market 59.7% for Port Adelaide (30% weight) + H2H form favouring Port Adelaide 1W-6L over last 7 (30% weight). The model and market align, both pointing to Port Adelaide. I applied 40% weight to Squiggle as it is mechanistic and transparent; 30% to the market (which includes bookmaker overround and should not be treated as ground truth); and 30% to H2H form, which shows a clear structural advantage to Port Adelaide in recent matchups.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~13 points (Port Adelaide)

The line market sets Port Adelaide -6.5 pts. However, Squiggle's expected margin of 13.7 pts is more reliable than the line market, which often under-reflects form trends due to betting volume dynamics. Both teams' recent scoring averages (Essendon 61.0 pts, Port Adelaide 66.2 pts) and both teams' defensive leakage rates (Essendon 114.0 pts conceded, Port Adelaide 120.6 pts conceded) suggest a moderate Port Adelaide victory. The H2H record shows Port Adelaide averaging 98.0 pts vs Essendon's 65.3 pts over the last 7 meetings, a 32.7 pt differential, but this is likely inflated by outlier wins; the 13.7 pt Squiggle estimate is more conservative and credible.

KEY FACTORS:

- H2H form disparity (1W-6L to Essendon over last 7): Port Adelaide has won 6 of the last 7 meetings. In the last meeting (Round 24, 2026), Port Adelaide won 133-70 at Adelaide Oval. Essendon's only recent H2H win was at Docklands in 2025 (72-60), over 12 months ago. This structural advantage to Port Adelaide is not coincidental.
- Season ladder position and win rate: Port Adelaide sits 15th with 6W-16L; Essendon sits 18th with 2W-20L. Port Adelaide has won 27.3% of games; Essendon has won 9.1%. Port Adelaide's 4-win gap reflects superior overall performance across the season, despite both teams' poor recent form.
- Recent margin decay (both teams collapsing equally): Essendon's average margin last 5 is -53.0 pts; Port Adelaide's is -54.4 pts. Both teams are losing heavily and comparably. However, Essendon's last 3 average shows defensive deterioration (124.7 pts conceded vs 114.0 over 5), whereas Port Adelaide's defensive trend is stable at 124.7. This suggests Essendon's vulnerability is accelerating.
- Docklands venue history (Port Adelaide underperforming but Essendon also underperforming there recently): Essendon's historical Docklands record is 126W-107L (54%, avg margin -0.4). Port Adelaide's is 32W-39L (45%, avg margin -7.0). However, in the last 5 games at Docklands, Essendon is 1W-4L (avg margin -42.8 pts) and Port Adelaide is 0W-5L (avg margin -25.8 pts). Port Adelaide's recent Docklands record is actually better (smaller loss margin) than Essendon's. The historical home advantage Essendon holds is being negated by current form collapse.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

- Essendon (last 5 games):
- Scoring for: 61.0 pts/game
 - Scoring against: 114.0 pts/game
 - Attack trend: stable
 - Defence trend: leaking more ^

- Essendon (last 3 games):
- Scoring for: 66.3 pts/game
 - Scoring against: 124.7 pts/game
 - Average margin: -58.4 pts

- Port Adelaide (last 5 games):
- Scoring for: 66.2 pts/game
 - Scoring against: 120.6 pts/game
 - Attack trend: stable
 - Defence trend: stable

- Port Adelaide (last 3 games):
- Scoring for: 63.0 pts/game
 - Scoring against: 124.7 pts/game
 - Average margin: -61.7 pts

Advantage: Port Adelaide has a modest offensive advantage (66.2 vs 61.0 pts over 5 games, a 5.2 pt gap). Both teams' defences are leaking at similar rates in the last 3 games (124.7 pts conceded). However, Essendon's defensive trend is deteriorating (note the 10.7 pt jump from 114.0 to 124.7 from 5 to 3 games), while Port Adelaide's defence is stable. Port Adelaide's attack, while slightly higher, is also slightly declining (66.2 to 63.0), suggesting both teams are equally fatigued. The key differentiator is Essendon's worsening defence, which favours Port Adelaide's already-marginally-better attack.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

- Essendon (home at Docklands) -- season:
- Home: 2/11 (18.2%)
 - Away: 0/11 (0%)

- Port Adelaide (away at Docklands) -- season:
- Home: 4/12 (33.3%)
 - Away: 2/10 (20%)

Essendon at Docklands (last 5): 1W-4L, avg margin -42.8 pts
Port Adelaide at Docklands (last 5): 0W-5L, avg margin -25.8 pts

Essendon historical Docklands (all-time): 126W-107L (54%), avg 96.9 vs 97.2 (margin -0.4) over 233 games
Port Adelaide historical Docklands (all-time): 32W-39L (45%), avg 94.3 vs 101.3 (margin -7.0) over 71 games

Analysis:
Essendon's historical Docklands record is 54%, a 6 pp advantage over Port Adelaide's 45%. This suggests Essendon normally benefits from playing at home. AFL home ground advantage is typically worth 8-15 pts (source: data notes). However, Essendon's season home record is severely degraded (18.2%), and their Docklands record over the last 5 games is -42.8 pts, far worse than their historical -0.4.

Port Adelaide's recent Docklands record (0W-5L, -25.8 pts) is actually superior to Essendon's recent home record. This suggests current form has inverted the usual home advantage. The historical advantage to Essendon is real (~6 pp or ~4-5 pts), but it is substantially offset by Essendon's season-long home collapse.

Estimated home advantage value for this match: +3 to +5 pts to Essendon, materially reduced from the typical 8-15 pt baseline due to Essendon's poor home record this season.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- Betting markets:
- H2H: Essendon \$2.2 (45.4% implied) | Port Adelaide \$1.68 (59.7% implied)
 - Line: Port Adelaide -6.5 pts
 - Totals: ~176 pts
- Squiggle model:
- Port Adelaide to win
 - Expected margin: 13.7 pts
 - Win probability: Essendon 41.0% | Port Adelaide 59.0%

Analysis:
All three data inputs (H2H market, line market, Squiggle model) agree: Port Adelaide is favoured. The line market implies a 6.5

Round 24 | SCG | 2026-08-23

Sydney vs North Melbourne

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Sydney 73% win probability approx. 32pt margin
Sydney \$2.17 (46.1% implied) | North Melbourne \$1.7 (58.9% implied) | Line: North Melbourne Kangaroos giving 6.2 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Sydney

WIN PROBABILITY: Sydney: 73% | North Melbourne: 27%

Derivation: Squiggle model (69.9% Sydney) weighted 45%, recent form & scoring margins (37.4pt avg for Sydney vs -11.0pt for North) weighted 35%, and betting market adjusted for overround (removing 4.7pp overround from \$2.17 odds) weighted 20%. The three sources align directionally on Sydney, justifying higher-than-market confidence.

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~32 points

Squiggle's 31.9pt expected margin aligns closely with Sydney's last-5 average margin of +37.4 and their SCG-specific last-5 average of +46.4. Adjusted downward slightly from the SCG trend to account for North Melbourne's improved attack trend (86.2 to 97.7 pts last-5 to last-3). The line market's 6.2pt North Melbourne spread is a significant outlier and is not credible given the weight of form and historical data.

KEY FACTORS:

1. Sydney's home dominance at SCG is extreme: Sydney's last-5 record at SCG is 4W-1L with +46.4pt average margin; North Melbourne's last-3 at SCG is 0W-3L with -40.3pt average margin. Historically, Sydney holds a 60% win rate at SCG (279W-186L) vs North's 56% (22W-17L), but the recent venue data is heavily skewed toward Sydney. This factor alone justifies a 20-25pt margin

adjustment in Sydney's favour.

2. Recent form disparity is substantial: Sydney has won 4 of 5 recent games with margins of +36, +97, +19, and +51pts. North Melbourne has won 1 of 5 with margins of -15, +23, -16, -31, and -16pts. Sydney's attack is averaging 119.2pts (last-5) and 128.7pts (last-3) while North's is 86.2pts and 97.7pts -- a 22-31pt scoring gap.
3. Head-to-head: Sydney dominance is near-total: Sydney has won the last 5 consecutive meetings and 7 of 7 recent matchups (100% win rate). Over the last 7 meetings, Sydney averages 107.0 vs North's 73.4 -- a 33.6pt average margin. This 7-game sample is far too large to dismiss as variance.
4. Ladder position reflects quality gap: Sydney is ranked 2nd (17W-5L, 68pts) with a 134.5% scoring ratio. North Melbourne is ranked 13th (9W-13L, 36pts) with a 90.7% scoring ratio. The 44-point gap and 5-win differential are structural, not noise.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

- Sydney (last-5): 119.2 pts for | 81.8 pts against. (last-3): 128.7 pts for | 78.0 pts against.
- Attack: improving ^ | Defence: stable
 - Trend interpretation: Sydney's attack has gained +9.5pts per game from the last-5 to last-3 window. Defence has tightened slightly (-3.8pts allowed). This is a team trending into form at the optimal moment.
- North Melbourne (last-5): 86.2 pts for | 97.2 pts against. (last-3): 97.7 pts for | 100.3 pts against.
- Attack: improving ^ | Defence: stable
 - Trend interpretation: North's attack has improved by +11.5pts (last-5 to last-3), a positive sign, but they are still 31pts per game below Sydney. Their defence has marginally worsened (-3.1pts allowed), suggesting their improvement is dependent on offensive execution rather than structural resilience.
- Scoring advantage: Sydney has a 31-40pt per-game advantage in absolute scoring output, and their trend is improving while North's improvement remains insufficient to bridge the gap.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

- Sydney (2026 season): 10W-1L at home (91%) | 7W-4L away (64%) -- 27 percentage-point home advantage.
- North Melbourne (2026 season): 6W-6L at home (50%) | 3W-7L away (30%) -- 20 percentage-point home advantage.
- Sydney at SCG (last 5 games): 4W-1L | average margin +46.4pts.
- North Melbourne at SCG (last 3 games): 0W-3L | average margin -40.3pts.
- Sydney at SCG (historical): 279W-186L (60% win rate) | average 102.2 vs 90.0 (margin +12.2) over 465 games.
- North Melbourne at SCG (historical): 22W-17L (56% win rate) | average 99.4 vs 97.1 (margin +2.4) over 39 games.

Home ground value for this match: AFL literature suggests 8-15pts for standard venues; SCG is a high-attendance fortress for Sydney. Sydney's 27pp home advantage this season (10W-1L) and +46.4pt average at SCG in the last-5 suggest home ground advantage is worth 15-20pts for Sydney in this context. North's away record (30%) and 0W-3L at SCG recently indicate significant disadvantage, effectively -10pts for them. Net Sydney advantage from venue: +18-22 points.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- H2H Market (Win/Loss): \$2.17 (Sydney implied 46.1%) vs \$1.70 (North implied 58.9%). These implied odds are inverted -- the market is pricing North Melbourne as the favourite despite all form, ladder, and venue data favouring Sydney. This is extraordinary and suggests possible market inefficiency or unusual sharp money on North.
- Line Market: North Melbourne giving 6.2pts. This market price implies a near-even contest with a slight North lean. This contradicts the form data and Squiggle model.

Squiggle Model: Sydney 69.9% | expected margin 31.9pts. This aligns with form and ladder data.

Reconciliation: The betting market (H2H and line) is a significant outlier. Squiggle, form data, ladder position, scoring averages, and SCG venue history all converge on a Sydney win by 25-40pts. The market's preference for North Melbourne cannot be explained by any data point in the dataset and may reflect:

- Sharp money responding to unannounced injury news (though none is confirmed);
- Public/casual money overweighting a potential upset narrative;
- Misreading of the suspension news.

Weight applied: Squiggle (45%) + Form/Scoring (35%) + Adjusted Market (20%). The market receives reduced weight due to internal contradiction and lack of supporting evidence.

FATIGUE & TRAVEL IMPACT:

Sydney: 7 days rest | home venue (no travel).

North Melbourne: 8 days rest | travel from Melbourne to Sydney (~1h25m flight).

Fatigue assessment: Both teams have adequate rest (7-8 days is standard). North Melbourne's travel is short-haul and low-fatigue (1.5 hours flight, short drive). The travel differential is negligible -- this is not a real fatigue factor. No impact on prediction.

WEATHER IMPACT:

Forecast for SCG on 2026-08-23: Max 18°C, Rain 0.8mm (39% chance), Wind 15 km/h.

Assessment: Conditions are mild and benign. Rain probability is only 39% and the rainfall projection is minimal (0.8mm). Wind at 15 km/h is typical winter AFL weather. Neither team's scoring profile suggests weather sensitivity -- both have been scoring consistently across recent rounds without weather-related disruption. Weather is neutral and will not materially affect the outcome.

TEAM NEWS IMPACT:

Sydney: Matthew Pavlich (CEO) announced suspensions to five Swans players following an incident ("Zero Hanger Injuries"). The

Round 24 | Perth Stadium | 2026-08-23

West Coast vs Hawthorn

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

TIP: Hawthorn

72% win probability approx. 28pt margin

West Coast \$9.03 (11.1% implied) | Hawthorn \$1.07 (93.7% implied) | Line: Hawthorn Hawks giving 46.4 pts

PREDICTED WINNER: Hawthorn

WIN PROBABILITY: West Coast: 28% | Hawthorn: 72%

(Weighted 40% Squiggle model [66.8% Hawthorn], 35% recent form and scoring trends [Hawthorn +22.4 avg margin vs West Coast -35.6], 15% betting market [93.7% implied], 10% home ground modifier. Squiggle and form data align strongly; betting market odds

appear to overstate Hawthorn's advantage slightly, but correction is modest given convergence of other inputs.)

PREDICTED MARGIN: ~28 points

(Squiggle expected margin 26.4 pts; line market 46.4 pts is an outlier. Hawthorn's last-5 average margin of +22.4 pts and West Coast's -35.6 pts suggest a 58-pt spread, but extreme form data (including a -70 pt loss to Fremantle) skew the West Coast average downward. Anchoring to Squiggle + average recent form differential yields ~28 pts as conservative middle ground between model and the more volatile recent margins.)

KEY FACTORS:

- Hawthorn's recent dominance in H2H: West Coast 0W-4L in last 4 meetings; Hawthorn average 115.5 pts vs West Coast average 52.5 pts in those games. This 63-point differential is the single strongest predictor in the dataset. No data supports West Coast reversing this trend.
- West Coast's current form collapse: 0/5 last 5 games with average margin -35.6 pts. Last 3 games average 76 pts for vs 104 against. Even accounting for home ground advantage (estimated 8-15 pts), West Coast's scoring output has deteriorated below sustainable levels. Hawthorn, despite slight recent softening (3/5 wins, -67 pt loss to Brisbane), averages +22.4 pts over last 5.
- Home ground advantage at Perth Stadium is material but insufficient to close the gap: West Coast 3/10 (30%) win rate at home this season vs 1/12 (8%) away; all-time Perth Stadium record 46W-61L (43%). Historical advantage at Perth is ~8-10 pts (margin 78.1 vs 87.9 across 107 games). This offsets ~1 ladder position but does not eliminate a 12-position gap (Hawthorn 4th, West Coast 16th).
- Hawthorn's away record remains strong despite recent loss: 6/10 (60%) away wins this season; historical 42% away win rate. Hawthorn's away form is markedly superior to West Coast's home form (60% vs 30%), suggesting travel and venue are not meaningful constraints for Hawthorn at this stage.

SCORING TRENDS ANALYSIS:

West Coast (last 5): 67.8 pts for, 103.4 pts against | (last 3): 76.0 pts for, 104.0 pts against
Attack trend: improving ^ (gain of 8.2 pts last 3 vs last 5) | Defence trend: stable (103.4 vs 104.0 -- negligible)

Hawthorn (last 5): 100.6 pts for, 78.2 pts against | (last 3): 83.0 pts for, 100.0 pts against
Attack trend: declining v (loss of 17.6 pts last 3 vs last 5) | Defence trend: leaking more ^ (conceding 21.8 additional pts last 3 vs last 5)

Advantage analysis: Despite Hawthorn's recent softening in both attack and defence, the team's scoring profile remains far ahead. Hawthorn 100.6 pts for vs West Coast 67.8 pts for (33-pt differential last 5) is decisive. West Coast's attack improvement of 8.2 pts is insufficient to close this gap. Hawthorn's defence deterioration (78.2 to 100.0) is concerning but still outperforms West Coast's 103.4 pts conceded. Hawthorn's absolute scoring advantage dominates the trend story.

HOME GROUND ADVANTAGE:

This season:

- West Coast: 3/10 home (30%) | 1/12 away (8%) -- +22pp home advantage this season
- Hawthorn: 9/12 home (75%) | 6/10 away (60%) -- +15pp home advantage this season

All-time:

- West Coast: 280/438 home (64%) | 172/438 away (39%) -- +25pp home advantage (multi-year pattern)
- Hawthorn: 570/1028 home (55%) | 430/1036 away (42%) -- +13pp home advantage

Venue-specific (Perth Stadium):

- West Coast: 46W-61L (43% win rate) | avg 78.1 for vs 87.9 against | avg margin -9.8 pts over 107 games
- Hawthorn: 4W-7L (36% win rate) | avg 75.4 for vs 73.9 against | avg margin +1.5 pts over 11 games
- West Coast last 5 at Perth: 0W-5L (avg margin -27.8 pts) -- significant recent deterioration vs all-time -9.8 pt average
- Hawthorn last 5 at Perth: 1W-4L (avg margin -9.8 pts)

Estimated home advantage value: AFL standard 8-15 pts. West Coast's multi-year +25pp home advantage suggests Perth Stadium is a moderate fortress (~10-12 pts base), but this season's 30% home win rate indicates the fortress effect has eroded materially. Current

season form suggests home advantage worth approximately 8-10 pts for West Coast, insufficient to overcome the Hawthorn form differential.

MARKET & MODEL ANALYSIS:

- H2H (Win/Loss) Market: West Coast \$9.03 (11.1% implied) | Hawthorn \$1.07 (93.7% implied)

Market assigns Hawthorn 82.6pp implied probability after removing overround. This is aggressive relative to historical AFL competitive balance.

- Line Market: Hawthorn giving 46.4 pts (expected margin)
This is notably larger than Squiggle's 26.4 pt prediction (difference of 20 pts) and significantly above recent form average differential (58-pt margin skewed by -70 pt loss). The line market appears overweighting recent extreme form variations.
- Totals Market: ~182 pts expected combined score
Below both teams' season averages (West Coast 171.2 pts for+against last 5; Hawthorn 178.8 last 5) but consistent with West Coast's recent deterioration in scoring output.
- Squiggle Model: Hawthorn 66.8% | West Coast 33.2% | margin 26.4 pts
Squiggle produces moderate, defensible predictions. Agrees with form direction (Hawthorn stronger) but applies greater regression to mean than raw recent form data.

Agreement/Disagreement: The betting market (93.7% Hawthorn) and Squiggle model (66.8% Hawthorn) diverge significantly -- 27pp difference. The line market (46.4 pts) also diverges from Squiggle (26.4 pts) by 20 pts. This suggests market may be overreacting to Hawthorn's absolute ladder position (4th) and recent wins vs West Coast, while underweighting reversion-to-mean factors and West Coast's home ground advantage.

Weighting decision: I weighted Squiggle 40% and form 35% over the 15% betting market allocation because:
 - Squiggle's 66.8% sits between raw form (which heavily favours Hawthorn due to -35.6 margin) and the market (93.7%).
 - Betting market probabilities have known bookmaker overround and may be subject to lopsided money flows on Hawthorn.
 - Historical accuracy of the